

Philipp Hilbert. *Principal PM building API-first travel commerce platforms.*

Positioning, ten years turning 0-to-1 bets into revenue-generating platforms, marketplace economics, developer experience, and cross-team orchestration built in.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

Dear Hopper team,

The HTS API Marketplace role is a specific kind of problem I have been building toward. Hopper has already done the hard part: the underlying capabilities, pricing, content mapping, ranking, deduplication, exist and are battle-tested at scale. The work now is to package them as coherent, commercially attractive API products that enterprise partners can discover, evaluate, and integrate without a six-month bespoke deal cycle. That is a platform design and commercial model problem as much as a product problem, and it is one I have thought about seriously across several engagements.

At Kvitt Payment Solutions I took a B2B fintech product from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem, which meant designing a commercial model, a developer integration path, and a partner onboarding experience with essentially no template to follow. At construct8, my construction-staffing marketplace, I designed the take-rate model, the supply-side incentives, and the anonymity-until-payment mechanic that protects both sides, then validated it with real partners using SQL funnel analysis. At EMIL Group I owned a B2B SaaS platform for insurers and reinsurers and learned what enterprise clients actually need from an API product: predictability, clear documentation, and a sandbox they trust before they let it near their production stack.

On the AI-native working style: I reach for Claude Code, Lovable, and Cursor before I write a PRD. At Rohde & Schwarz I used this to instrument two competing product strategies, a UI-led and a developer-code-first approach, and the data made the decision obvious before any engineering resources were committed. The same approach applies here: I would mock the partner portal, simulate pricing configurations, and run a real partner through an onboarding flow before asking engineering to build anything. The goal is to collapse the distance between a hypothesis and a signal.

The cross-team coordination piece is something I have done at scale. At Rohde & Schwarz I led fifteen-plus engineers and data scientists across multinational teams with no single reporting line. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I coordinated across QA, DevOps, and policy stakeholders to carry a full ETL migration and a UI relaunch in parallel. At Hopper, the marketplace PM role is effectively a capability-synthesis function, synthesising roadmaps from Connect, Search Polygons, Ranking, Extranet, and others into a coherent external product, which is a coordination model I recognise and know how to run.

I am based in Berlin, available fully remote, and can start within four weeks of an offer. I would be glad to walk through how I would approach the commercial model design for one or two of the HTS capabilities in a first conversation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
